Early, Not Rushed

The Family Planner

For parents and students building a learning path that fits.

[NAME]

How to use this planner

1. Fill in the Year-at-a-Glance together.
2. Copy the Weekly Planner each week (print several).
3. Do the Monthly Check-In on the same day each month.
4. Keep the Records Tracker updated every term.
5. Use the College Questions page before talking to any college.
6. Use the Reset Plan when things feel stuck.

Print on regular paper. Pencil works best, because plans change, and that is the point.

General planning tool from one family's experience. Not educational, legal, medical or psychological advice. Check your state's rules.

Year at a Glance

Where we are, where we might go, and what we will try. Review every term.

Learner's name or nickname (no personal details needed)

	Where we are now	What's working	What isn't	One thing we'll try
Learning style (live instructor, online instructor, reading, hands-on)				
Pace				
Daily structure				
Social life				
Goals (not just graduation)				

Route we are considering (stay + depth, subject acceleration, grade skip, early graduation, dual enrollment, online instructor, mix)

What would tell us it's time to slow down?

Next review date

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Weekly Planner

Week of _____ · Energy this week (1-5): ____

Day	Learning block 1 energy ★★★	Learning block 2	Break / movement	Social or activity time
Monday				
Tuesday				
Wednesday				
Thursday				
Friday				
Weekend				

Just for fun slot (protected)

Friday 5-minute review

What worked

What to change

> Author's note: my own school day ran from about 9 to 2, which left the rest of the day free for other activities and things I was interested in. Plan what you will *do* with the free time, so it feels like a gift and not a gap.

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Monthly Check-In

Sit down together, relaxed. Month of _____

Learner fills this in

Something I enjoyed this month

Something that was hard

Something I want to change

My energy right now (1-5): 1 2 3 4 5

I want to go: faster / slower / the same

Parent fills this in

I noticed they seemed

Something I'm worried about

Something I'll change on my side

> Honest, not for judging. If you see ongoing dread, loss of interest, or changes in sleep or mood, slow down and talk to a qualified professional if you are worried.

Decision for next month (together)

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Records Tracker

Keep these safe. Update every term.

Item	Where it's stored	Last updated	Needed for
Course list			
Official transcripts			
Diploma / graduation records			
Activity log (clubs, groups, volunteering)			
Work samples			
Test results			
Enrollment communication			

Notes: state or district rules to check

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College Questions Checklist

Ask before committing. Write the answer, the date and who answered.

Question	Answer	Date / who
Age and grade requirements? Any exceptions?		
Which tests, transcripts or interviews are needed?		
What does it cost? Any programs that help?		
Which credits transfer, and where? (Get it in writing.)		
In person, online, or hybrid?		
Who is our contact? Is there a counselor or advisor?		
Rules about parents being involved for a minor?		
Effect on financial aid and future admissions?		
Withdrawal policy if it isn't working?		

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Reset Plan

Use when everything feels stuck. A rough stretch is a signal to adjust, not a failure.

What's been hardest

What we're pausing

What we're keeping

The one thing we'll change

Who we'll talk to (trusted adult, mentor, professional)

Steps

1. Stop adding new commitments for two weeks.
2. Have one honest conversation.
3. Protect sleep, play and friends.
4. Pick one thing to change.
5. Recheck in two weeks.
6. Decide together: continue, adjust or pause.

Review date

> If your child seems consistently sad, anxious, withdrawn or unsafe, or you are worried about their health, please contact a doctor, counselor or other qualified professional.

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